

Lecture 9

Unit 7 Ambition and Success--Definition

Definition

Purposes

- To clarify an abstract or controversial term or concept.
- To explain an unfamiliar term from a particular culture, geographical area, field of study or profession.
- To inform and entertain a particular interested group of readers by giving various kinds of information about a term or concept.

Categories

Sentence Definition

Formal Sentence Definition

Term + Verb(be) + General Class + Distinguish features

Commonly Used Sentence Strategies

- with a dash(--)
- with a subordinate clause
- an appositive phrase
- "define as" "refer to" "consist in"

Extended Definition

Consist of several sentences or several paragraphs. Usually offer an original perspective.

Strategies

- Describe the features and parts of the subject, or the class the subject belongs to
- Give examples
- Compare and contrast
- Trace the subject's history or development
- Analyze the subject's causes or effects
- Discuss the subject's etymology or origin

Avoid

- unnecessary dictionary definitions
- circular definition

Structure

Introduction

Body

Conclusion

Criteria of Writing

Complement of Goals

Unity and coherence

unity: all the sentences support the topic sentence

coherence: the ideas logically related.

Lexical

Grammar